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Data Analysis

Data analysis is an extremely important step to help us understand how to approach the given problem since we can get an idea of which data are relevant and important to use and which needs to be removed. We distinguished some of the patterns that our initial data had and we found three main categories:

- | |
|---|
| 1. Data with a specific structure with their respective subtitle(e.g Date Opened:). |
| 2. Repeated paragraphs describing a recall. |
| 3. Data containing html tags |

This step helps us clarify where we need to focus when we preprocess the data so that we can remove most of the noise and keep the valuable information in order to achieve a better prediction.

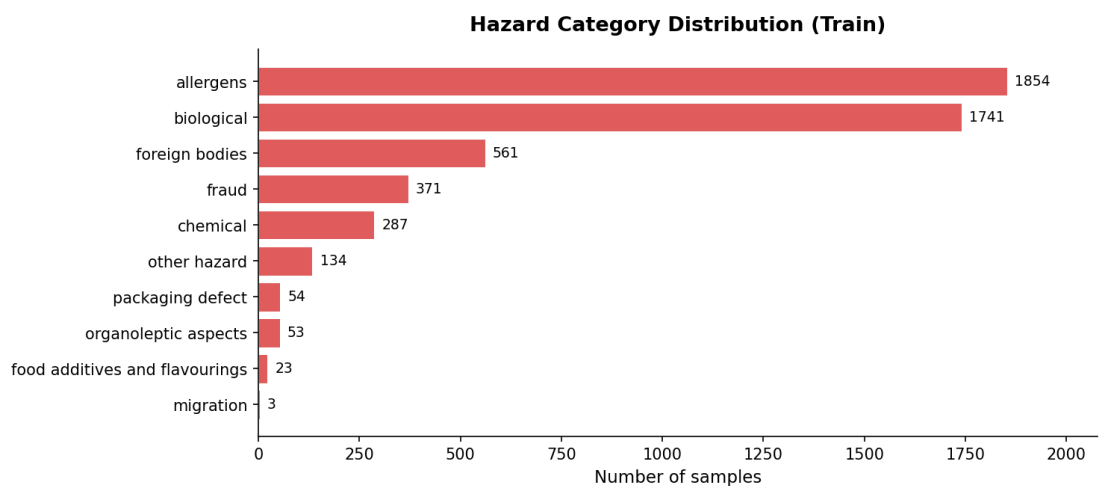
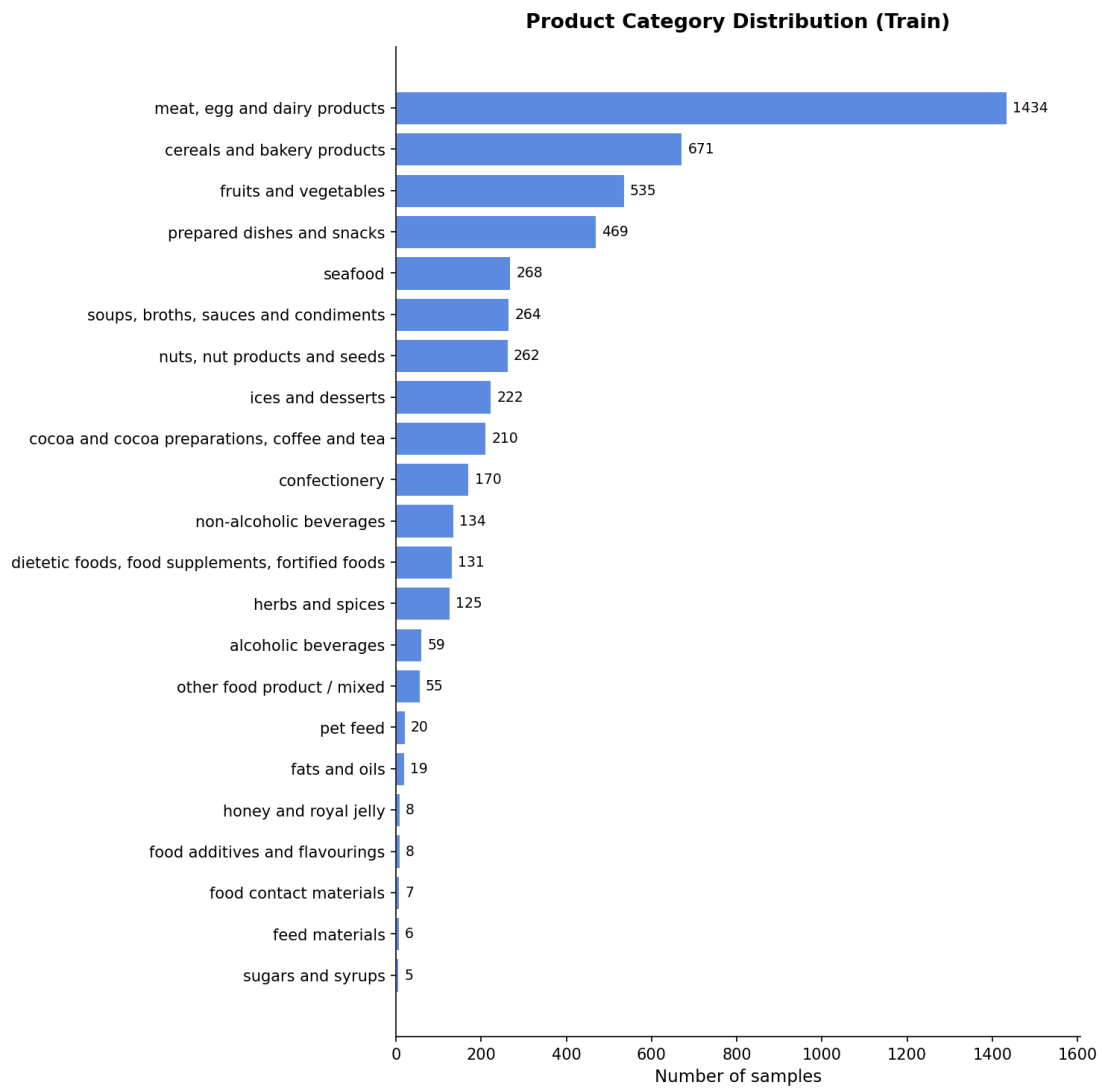
The next step was to locate imbalance on our categories as mentioned on the instructions of our task. We can clearly see through an example that a hazard-category of “packaging defect” appears a lot less than “allergens”. This observation is crucial because it will directly affect our model due to having minimal training data for one category and a plethora of training data on the other. This can lead to a lot of different paths on how we can overcome the problem with some ways being:

- | |
|--|
| • Adding more training data to these categories |
| • Undersampling categories with more training data than others |
| • Higher penalization when guessing wrong classes that are shown less |
| • Having a confusion matrix when evaluating to find this imbalanced domination of one class over the other |

We decided not to implement any of the above other than the confusion matrix since we already achieved a decent score with the baseline methods.

Finally we did not find any unusual characters or the use of another language other than English so we will not have to factor them in at the preprocessing stage.

Visualization of the categories



Preprocessing

The preprocessing stage is where the data analysis is being implemented on our data and start to go from observations to actions.

Our first step was to remove duplicate lines from our data which is achieved by iterating each line of our data and depending on if we have seen again a line or not we either discard it or add it to a list of unique lines.

Our second action is to convert our words to lower case since having upper case words would count as different instances and do not give us any additional information. We also targeted specific occurrences such as urls, numbers, emails and html tags because they are just noise.

Then we created a labels list and added some specific patterns we found throughout the data analysis stage. These patterns are words and phrases that seemed to be present on a lot of texts, so we captured most of them and removed them from our words list.

Next, we removed punctuations and special characters such as (\n, whitespaces).

At last, we used methods such as stemming and removing stop words. These two provide some way of dimensionality reduction. Stemming can fuse multiple words of the same family into one (e.g activation and activate can be written as active) where on the other hand stop words remove unnecessary words that are fillers with no meaningful information. Note that for the stop words we also created a custom stop word list of our own with words that we had found from our analysis and thought the imported library might not include them (e.g january). Finally, words such as: not etc, were not quarantined from our stop words because the format of the given text explicitly states the hazard and the product, so keeping it would not help our model with better predictions. We also discarded words with length <2, so characters that cannot provide us useful information.

Feature Extraction Document Term Matrix

For the baseline solution we used two different methods, the tf-idf and the word2vec.

The tf-idf method creates an array where each row represents a vector of a document and each column represents a vector of a word. In this way we can calculate for a given word, its frequency on each document and for a given document, we can calculate the frequency of each word in it. This method is called via the TfidfVectorizer from the library sklearn and we gave it as input the min_df = 5 where words that are present on less than 5 documents are excluded and max_df = 0.85 where words are present on more than 85% of the documents are excluded. Finally, we call the method fit_transform

Word2vec method is from the same library but utilizes the words in a different way. As parameters it takes the following:

• Sentences: is a list of all the words in a document
• Vector_size: the size of the vector that each word has
• Window: the number of words that will be used for skipgram
• Min_count: ignores words with lower frequency than what is set
• Sg : mode for skipgram or cbow
• Workers: number of threads to be utilized
• Seed: static value for consistency in test results since vectors are randomly initialized

Word2vec can be implemented using cbow or skipgram. Cbow (Continuous bag of words) is a method where it is using its surrounding words to predict the center word whereas skipgram uses the center word to predict the surroundings relative to the value of window. Based on the theory cbow is always worse than skipgram so we decided to not implement it at all.

Since word2vec is creating a vector for each word and a document contains a lot of them, after calling word2vec we take the mean and produce a final vector with size the value of vector_size through calling the method get_doc_vector. Note that to get the correct dimension of the final vector when we calculate the mean with the library numpy, we also need to specify axis =0.

At this stage we fit and transform our data to get them ready for our models. When we say fit, we mean the creation of the vocabulary whereas, transformation is the procedure where we turn the words into vectors and create the correct dimensions.

Dimensionality Reduction

We only used SVD on the tf-idf method from the sklearn library with parameters:

• n_components: the size of the final vector
• seed: static value for consistency in test results since vectors are randomly initialized

Since we have done a lot of preprocessing, reducing the dimensions will not give us any substantial benefit because there is not really any noise left inside our words.

Model Learning

For our baseline we used the following models from the sklearn library:

• MultinomialBayes
• ComplementBayes
• GaussianBayes
• Logistic Regression

MultinomialBayes assumes that each word is independent from all the others. It calculates the probability of each category and then it calculates the probability of the word based on the category that it is given. Then the final probability is the product of the prior probability of the category and the conditional probabilities of all the words found in the document.

ComplementBayes is the tuned version of the MultinomialBayes and is more fit for our problem since we have imbalanced categories. This method does not calculate the probability of the word based on the category that it is given but it calculates the probability of the word based on not being on all others.

GaussianBayes is used for the SVD and word2vec implementation and uses the mean and standard deviation of a word in a category. It is used on these two because these methods can produce negative values and only the GaussianBayes of the 3 above can interpret negative values.

Logistic Regression uses a sigmoid activation function and assigns weight to each word giving the probability of a word being in a specific category. Using as parameter the `class_weight = balanced` we can achieve what the above couldn't, fixing the category imbalance problem. We also set a max iteration for 2000 since we have a lot of words, and it states after how many iterations the algorithm will stop if it hasn't already decided the optimal settings.

All the above models use methods that fit and predict. At the model stage when we use fit, we essentially train our model based on the training data so it can learn how to distinguish which text corresponds to the correct category. When it comes to testing, we can only transform the testing data to create the vectors and then we use the predict method to let our model guess the correct category.

Fine Tuning

The use of optimal parameters can significantly improve our model and is a necessary step. Fine tuning is this specific procedure, and we implemented it for the logistic regression model. We used the gridSearchCV method from sklearn to achieve that giving it the following parameters:

- Base_lr: is the logistic regression as shown above
- Param_grid: a list of values that we want to find the best from them
- Cv: 5 is the default value and represents a 5-fold cross validation. This means that the training data are split into 5 parts and each time each part is a validation set that we see how many we got correct based on the training of the other four. On the next iteration we take the next part and do the same procedure.
- Scoring: we chose the scoring method of cross-validation. We used the f1 macro
- N_jobs: we set it to -1 so we use all the processing power.

For the logistic regression we gave a param_grid of $C = [0.1, 1.0, 10.0, 100.0]$. This parameter is a penalization factor. When its low our model is simpler and captures the “big picture” which helps from overfitting. Having higher value gives the model more freedom which helps take into consideration rarer words but has the risk of overfitting.

Text Categorization

At this stage we decided to implement a method called ensembling. Instead of running each method alone and picking the best of them we combined multiple methods together so each one can contribute its predictions and have a more spherical answer. We chose logistic regression and complement Bayes since both use the tf-idf. To add Multinomial Bayes would only hurt us since complement Bayes is already better and to add Gaussian Naïve Bayes, we would have to bring tf-idf and word2vec and svd into the same dimensions which seemed a little hard to do. We used the method VotingClassifier that takes as estimators the logistic regression and complement Bayes and as a voting parameter we set it to soft which takes the mean of the two probabilities of the predictions.

State of the Art Implementation

The last implementation we tried was a state-of-the-art method using a BERT model. The first step was to change the clean text function by cleaning only duplicate lines, urls, emails and html tags. We didn't use any stemming, stop

word removal, lower casing the words and removing numbers because the transformers need that information and by removing it, we worsen the model's learning ability. The next step is to add a focal loss function for our model. This is important due to the imbalance of our data. Its use is to reduce the weight of usual examples and reinforce the weight of rare classes such as (migration, honey and royal jelly, food additives and flavorings, sugar and syrups, feed materials). To balance the data, we also augmented the train set by choosing the above categories, finding examples from the train set and giving them to known LLMs and creating similar examples. We created 20 examples for each category and added them to the bottom of the train csv file.

Later we created the train_transformer method where we transform the categories into numbers and compute their weights. At this point we also used the clamp method from pytorch because some classes gave as "nan" values because we had no occurrences. Then we take the altered train and valid datasets and we tokenize them. Since most of the text contains a lot of words, we used a max_length of 512 but note that on weaker graphics cards, this size can give a memory error. After that we load our model and set its arguments. We specified the number of epochs, the batch size for the training and validation, the warmup_ratio which gradually bumps up the learning rate in order to have smooth steps at the beginning, the warmup_decay which applies a penalty when the model relies too heavily on a specific word forcing its attention to the whole sentence, eval/save_strategy= "epoch" which stores and evaluates the model against the validation set at the end of each epoch, load_best_model_at_end which loads the best checkpoint it found, learning_rate which is how quickly it learns from the data set, metric_for_best_model which specifies the evaluation function for the load_best_model_at_end, greater_is_better which specifies that the best f1 score achieved at an epoch is the optimal, save_total_limit which helps with the disk space occupied from saving each epoch, bf16 which uses 16 bit numbers instead of 32 helping with vram usage and matrix multiplications and logging_steps which prints the training loss for every given batch.

Finally, we pass our trainer through the Focal Loss function, begin the train and once it's finished, we start the prediction on the validation set and convert the numbers again to their category.

Evaluation

The creation of stats and evaluating them is important to find out what methods worked, where we missed some predictions and the overall general predictivity of our model.

First, we implemented the given equation using the f1 score. We gave it as parameters below:

• Y_true_hazard: the real hazards
• Y_pred_hazard: the predicted hazards
• Average: a macro f1 score
• Zero division: we set it to 0 so classes that haven't been predicted at all correspond to a score of 0 and don't give as an error

Then using the numpy library we create an array that has True/False based on if we predicted the answer correctly or not. From that we can find the predicted products categories based on correct predictions of hazard categories. Then we calculate the final score.

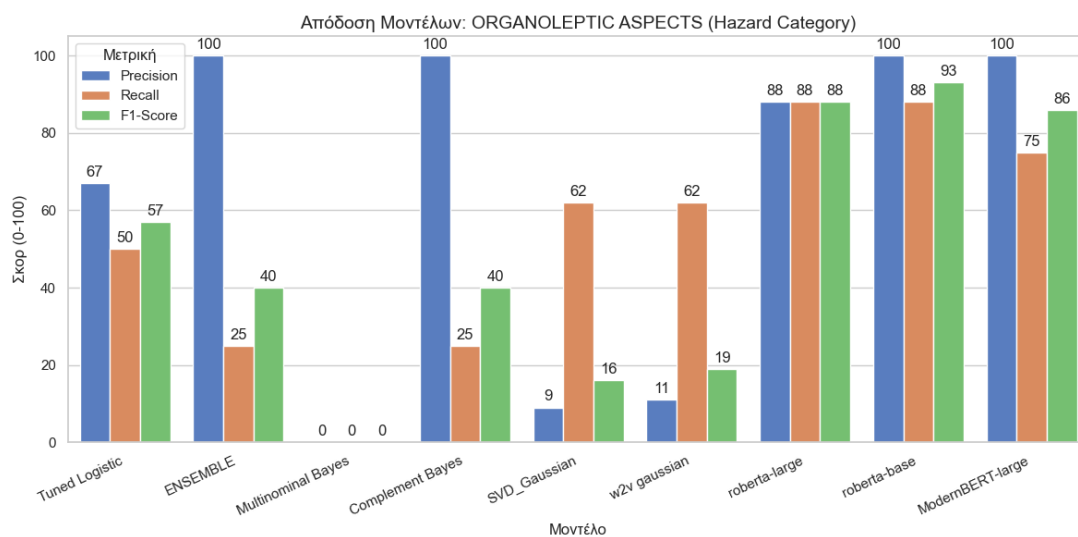
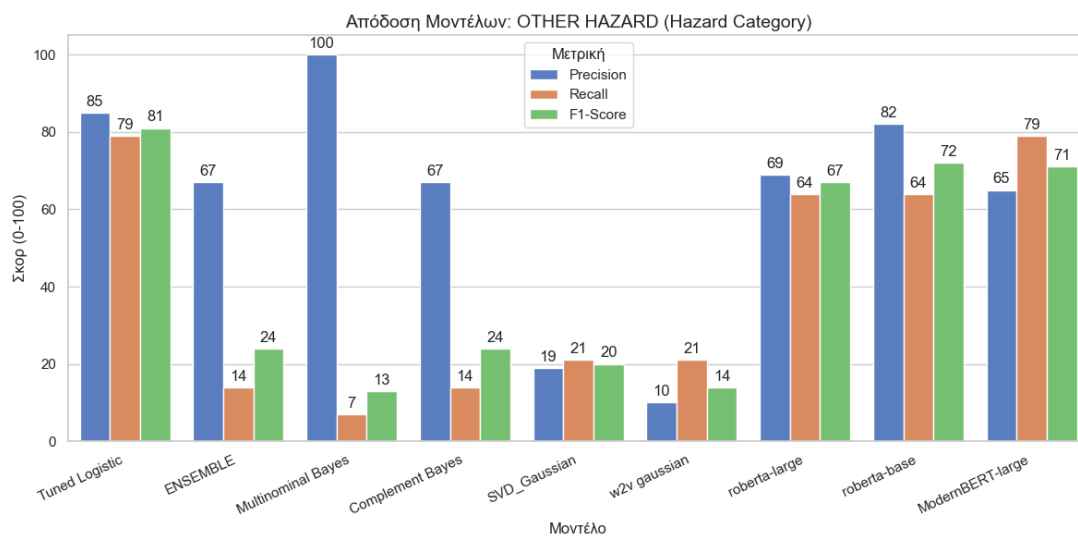
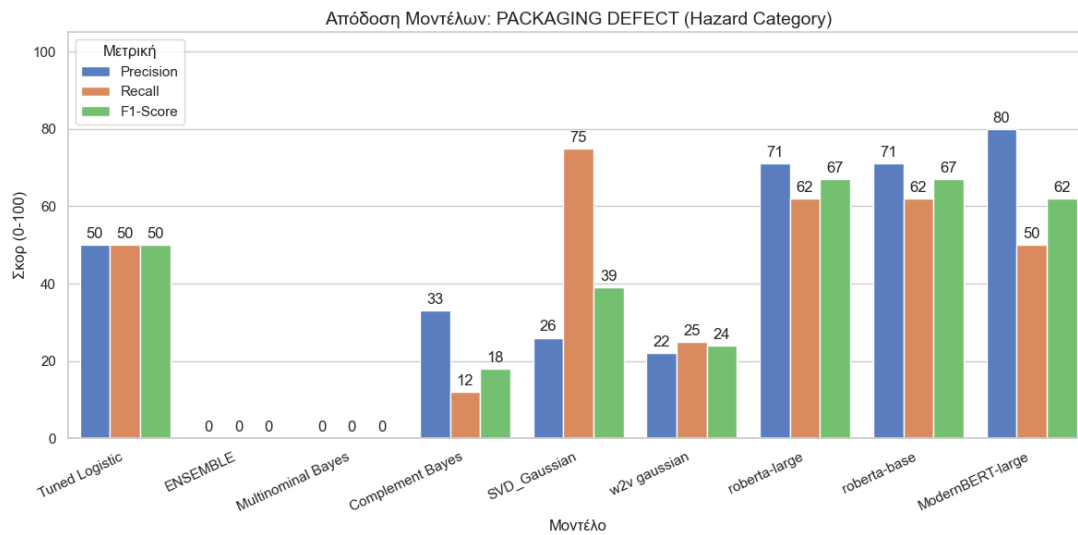
Then we used the method `classification_report` on both categories showing us the following:

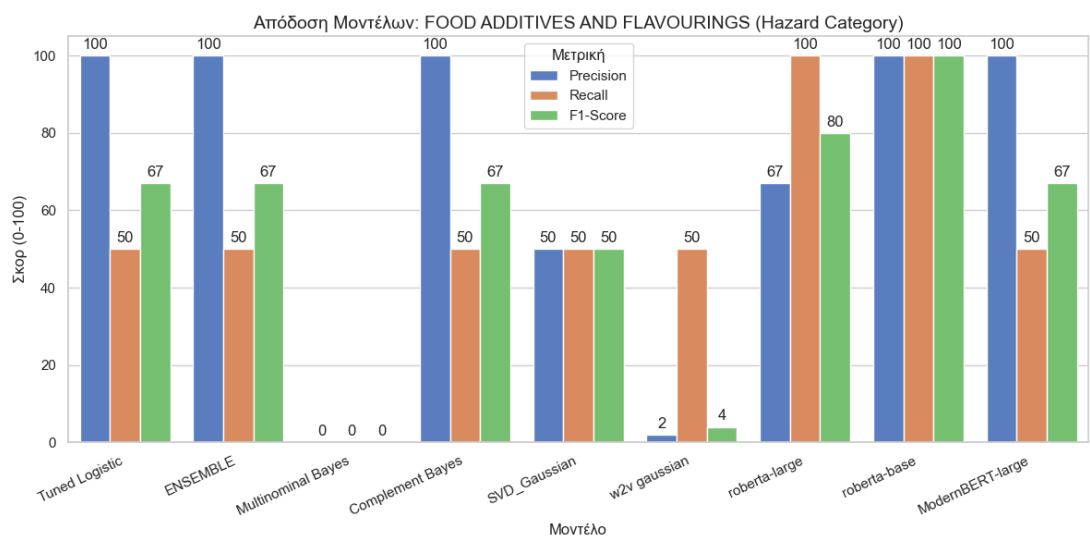
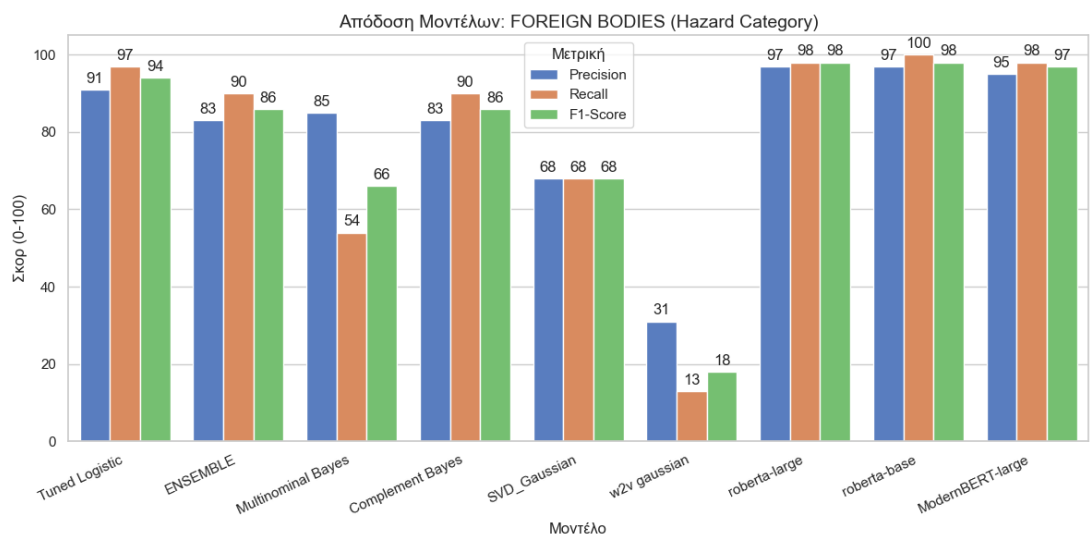
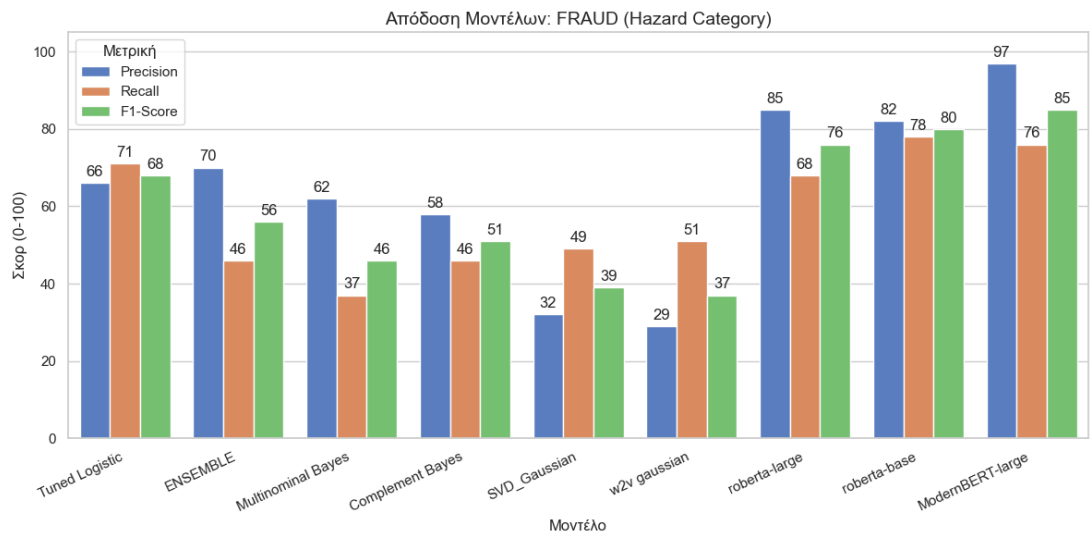
• Precision: the accuracy of correct predictions. Lower scores mean that we have false positives.
• Recall: how many correct answers we found from the data. Lower scores mean that we have false negatives.
• F1-score: Specialized mean of precision and recall. High imbalances between precision and recall provide a low score.
• Support: How many true samples were inside the data.

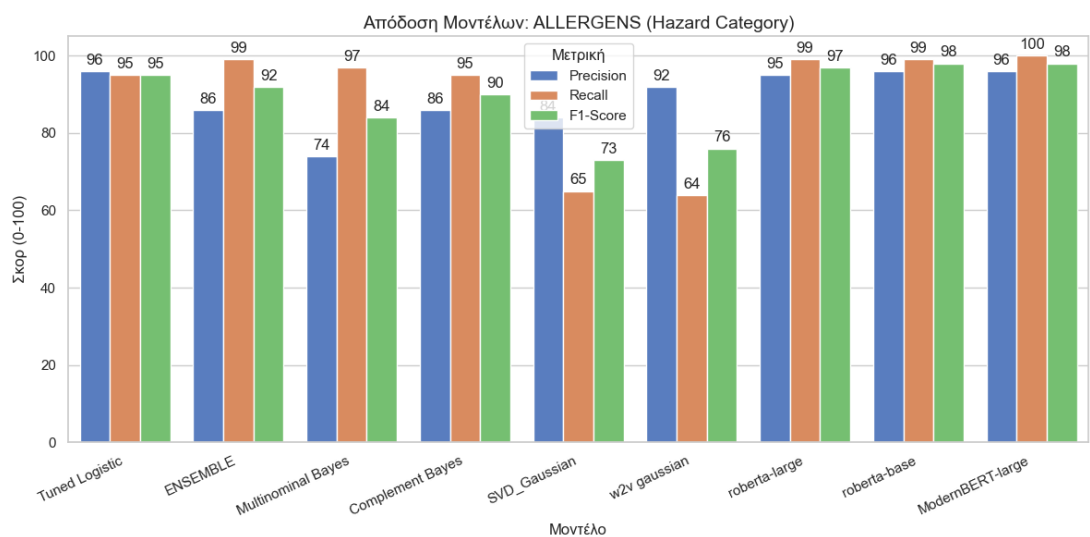
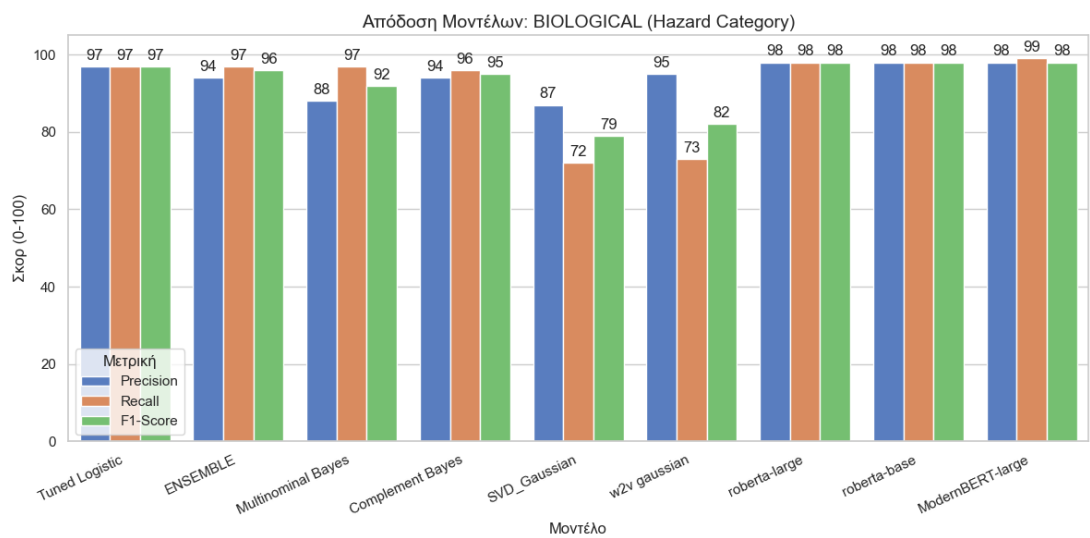
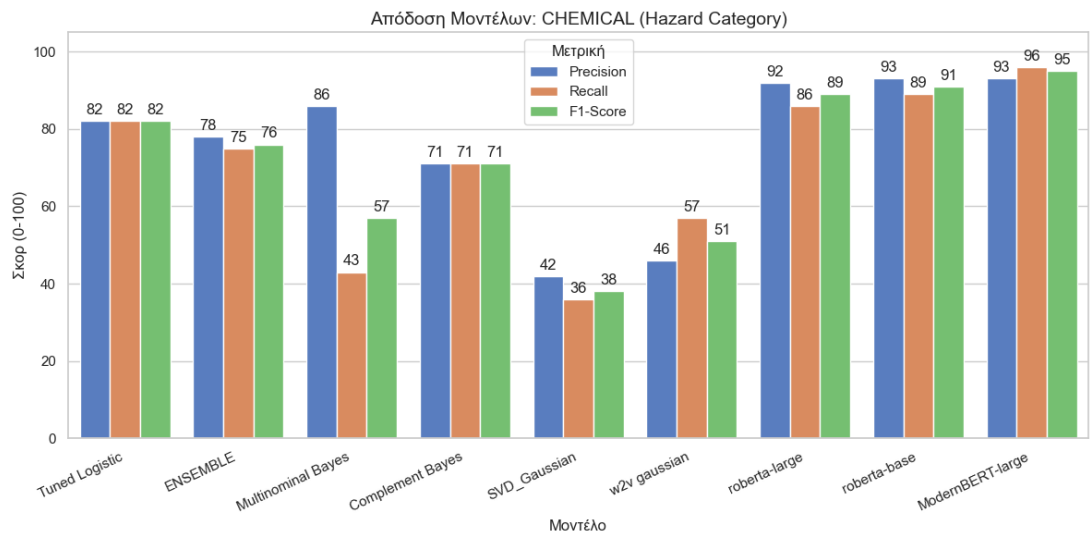
Our last metric is a confusion matrix. This matrix describes on its rows the real number of instances that belong in a category and the columns show how many instances our model predicted that belong in that category while the diagonal shows us the true positives.

Below are listed the results of each method. Later we will discuss our observations based on the results:

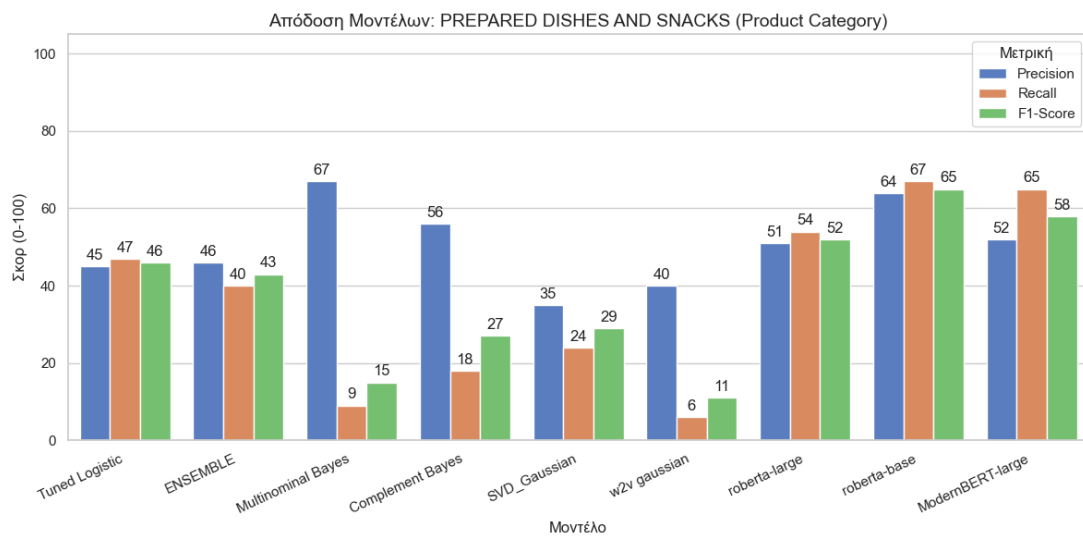
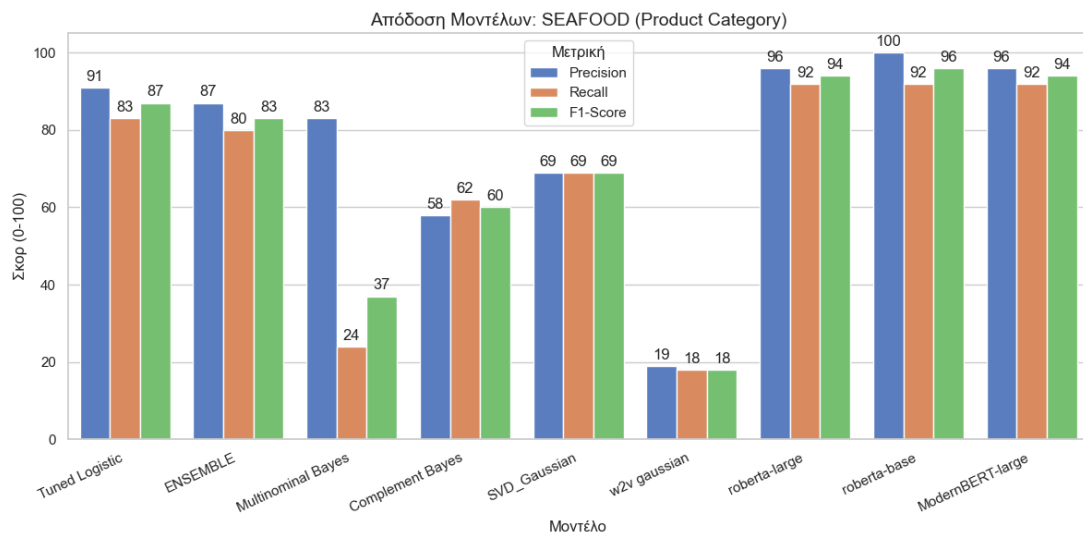
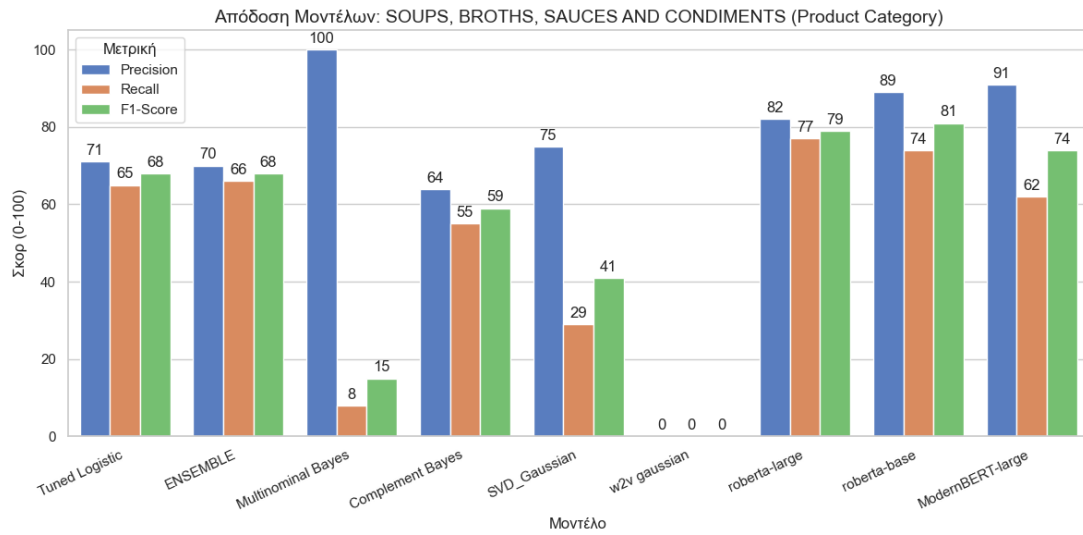
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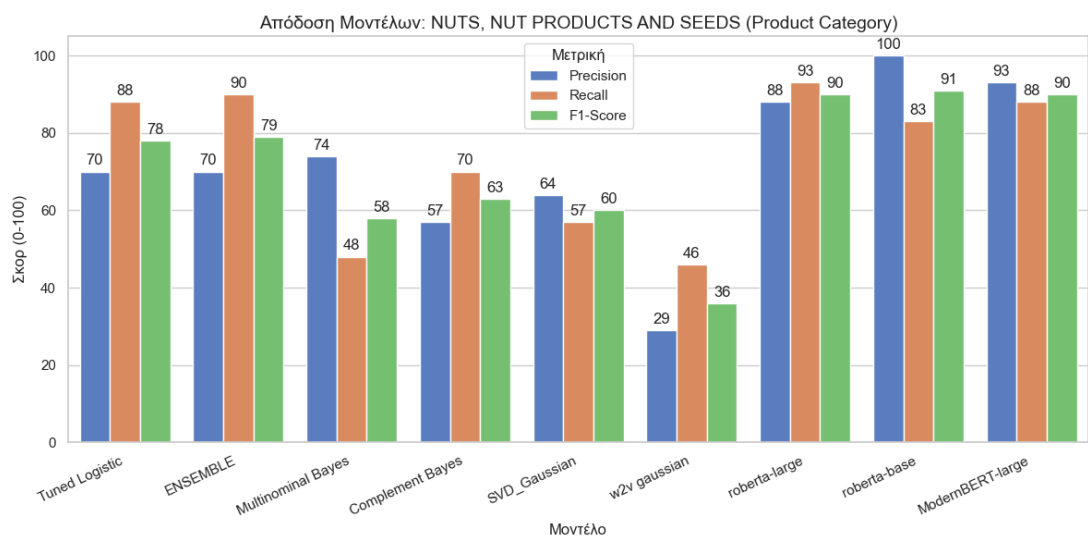
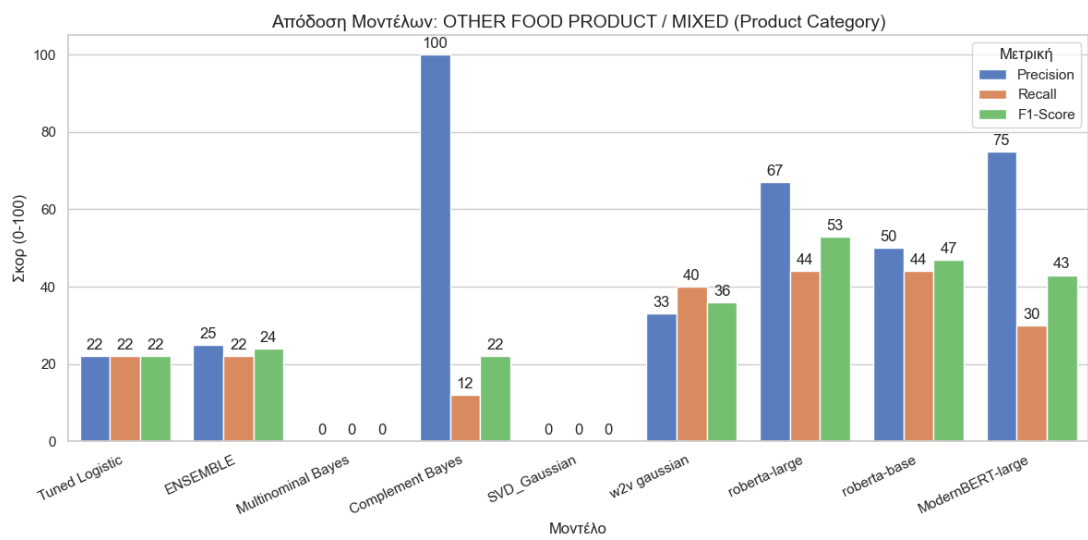
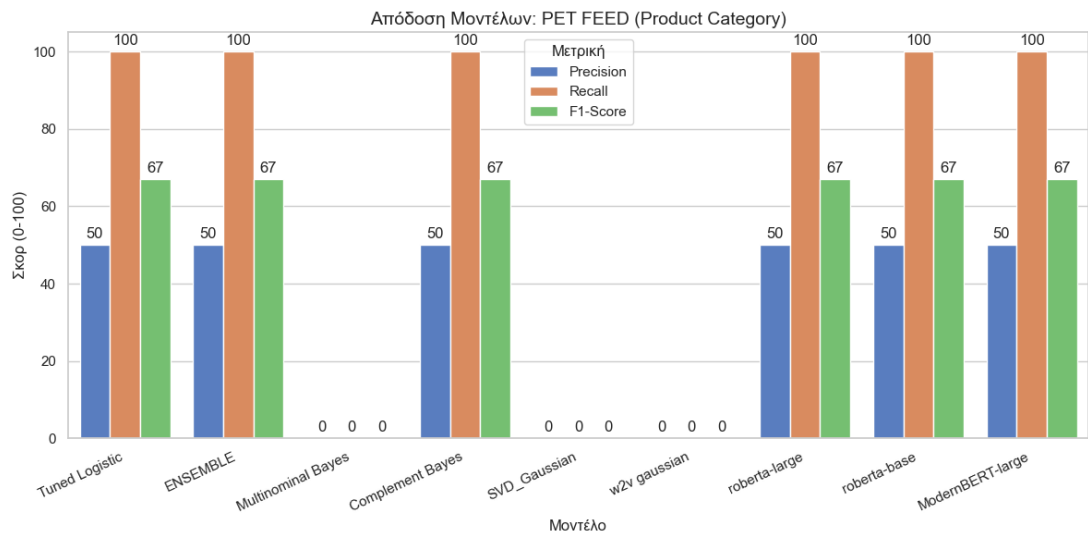


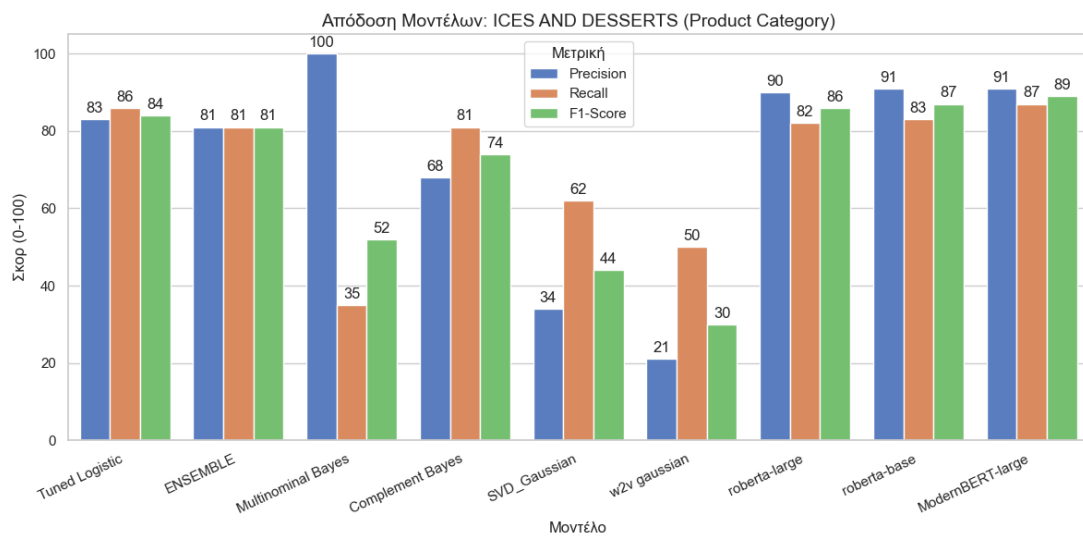
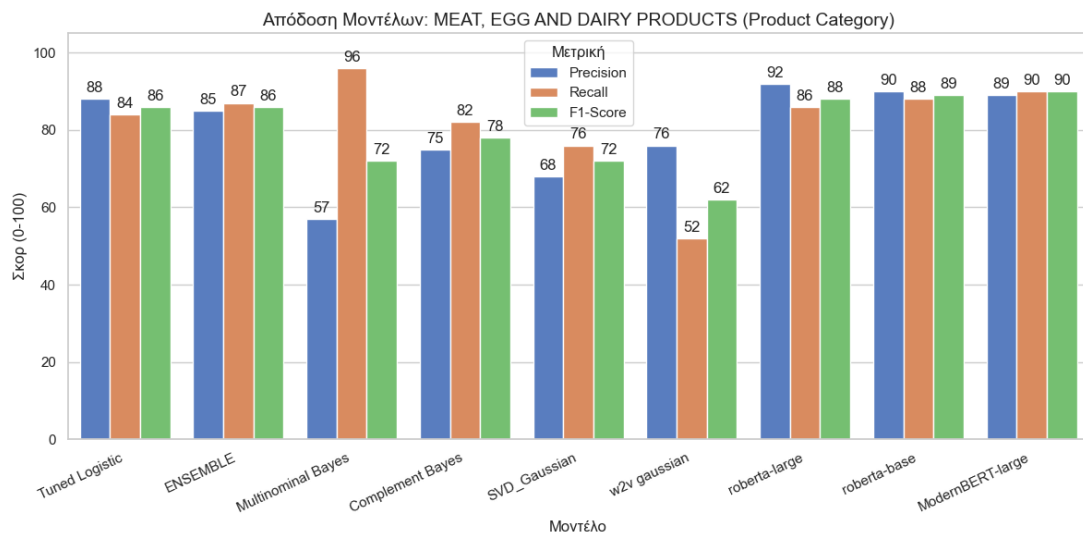
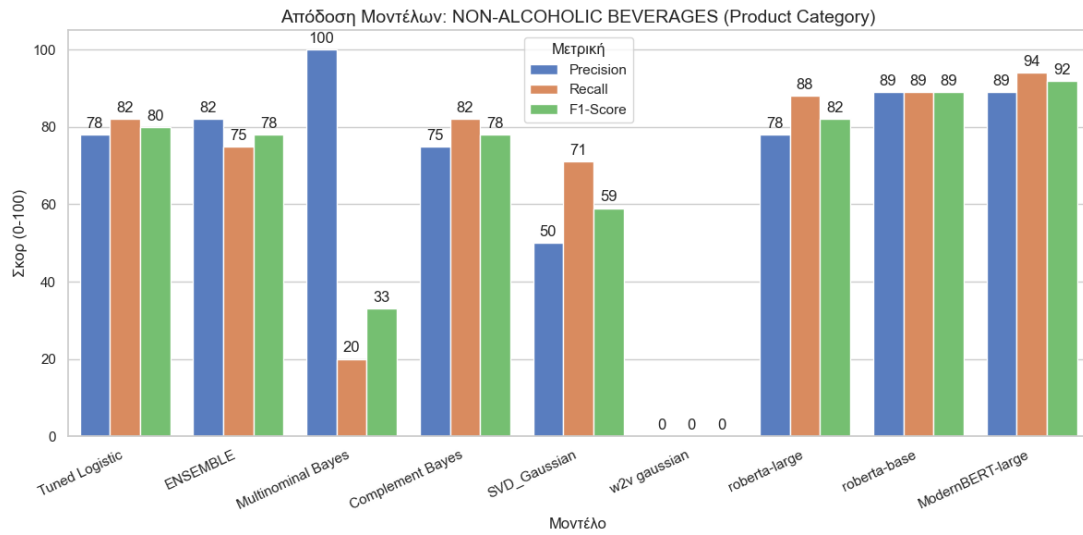


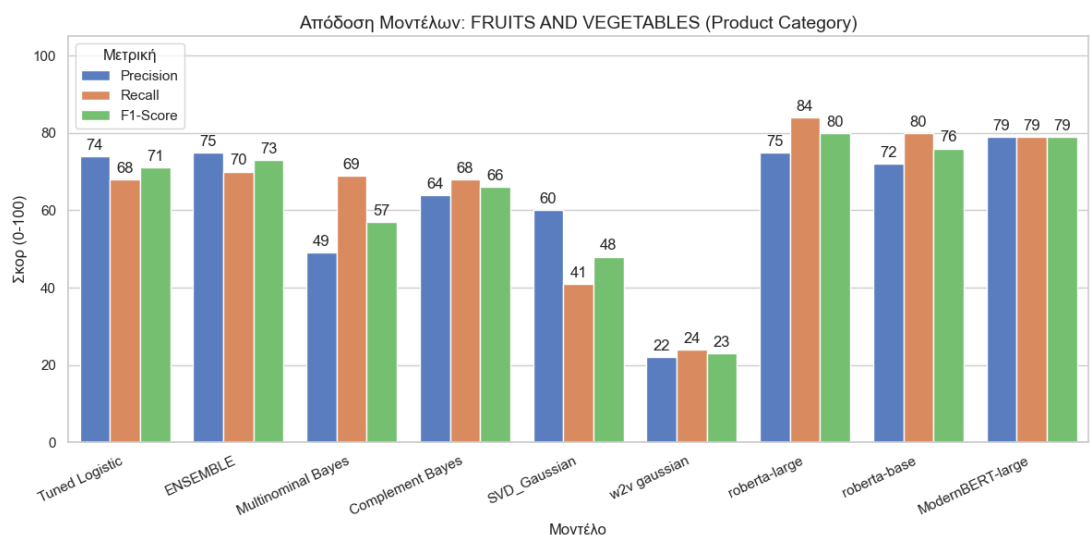
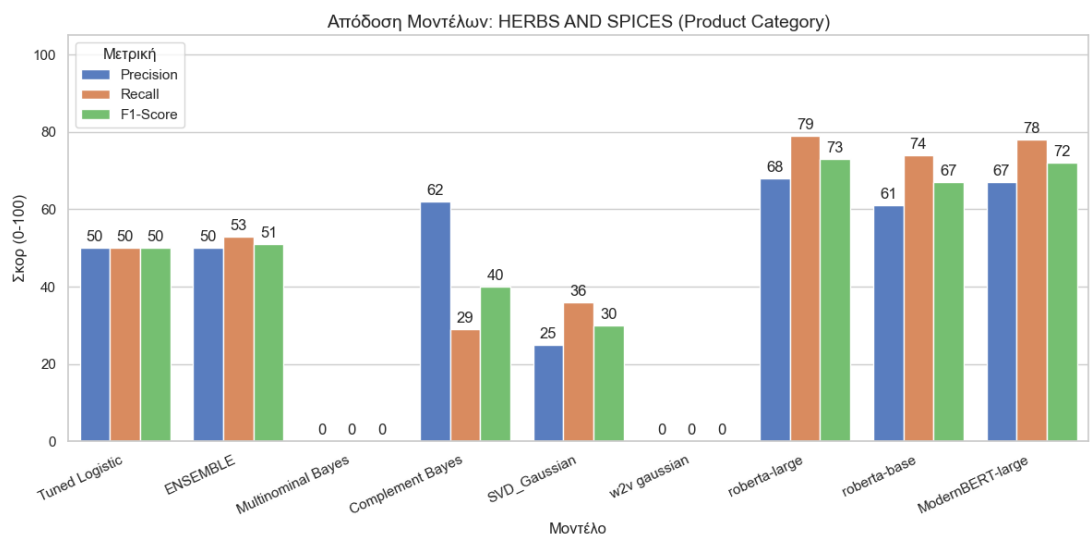
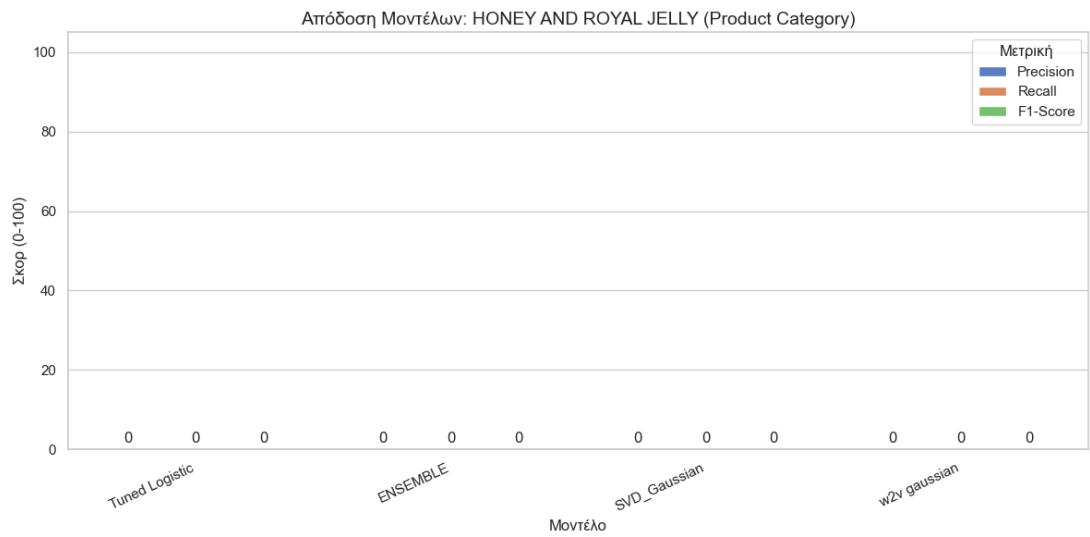


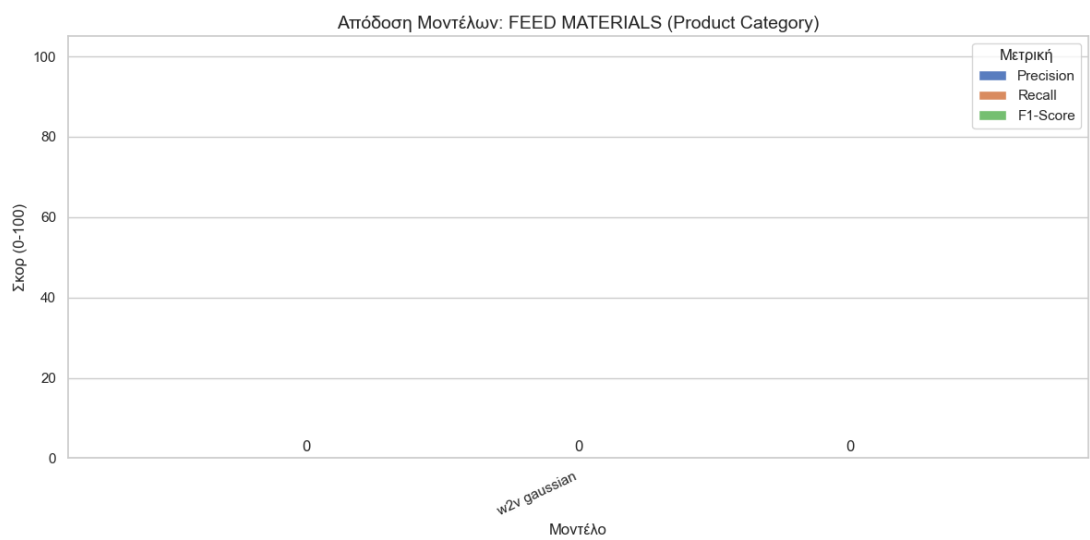
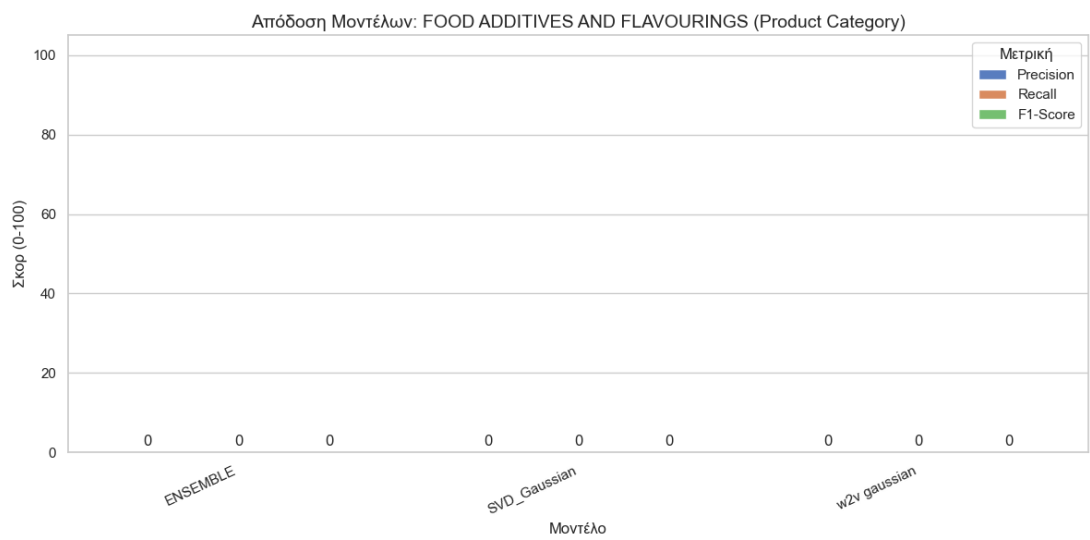
Products

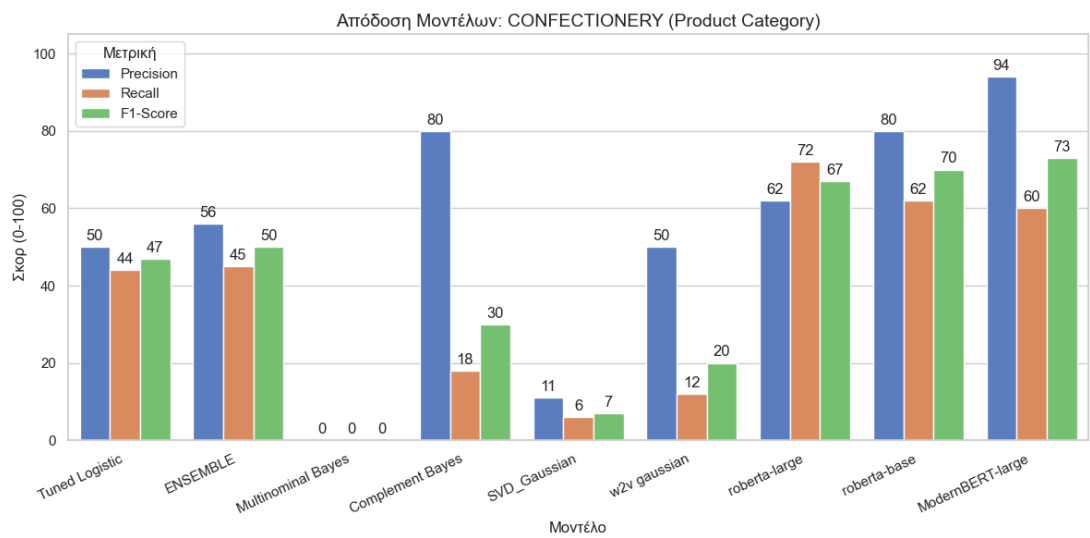
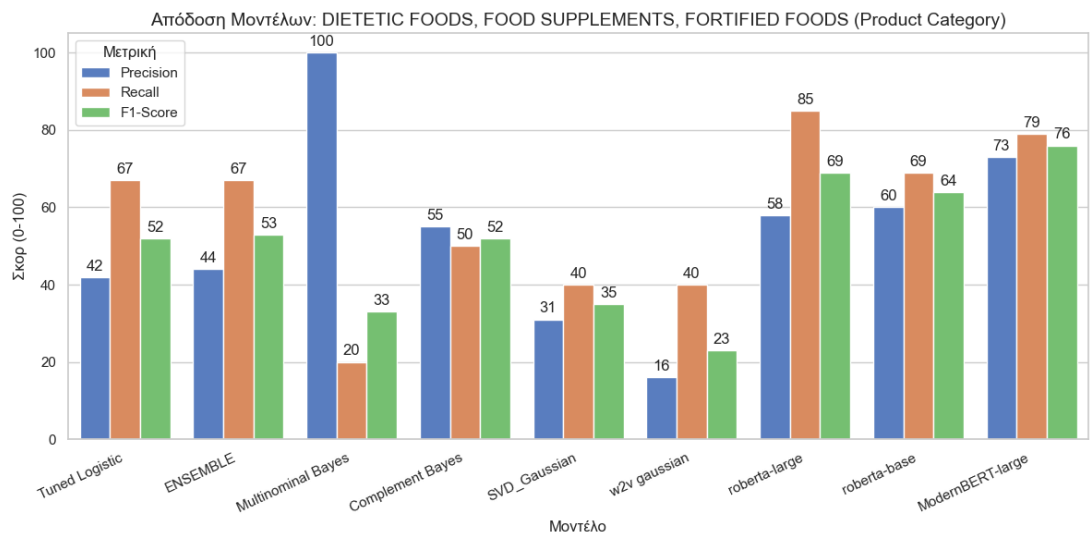
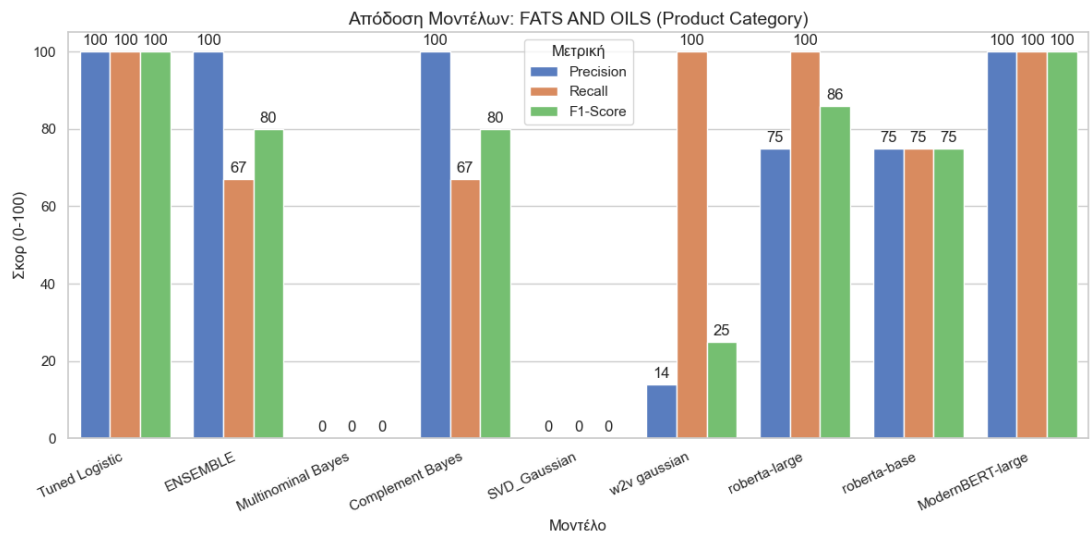


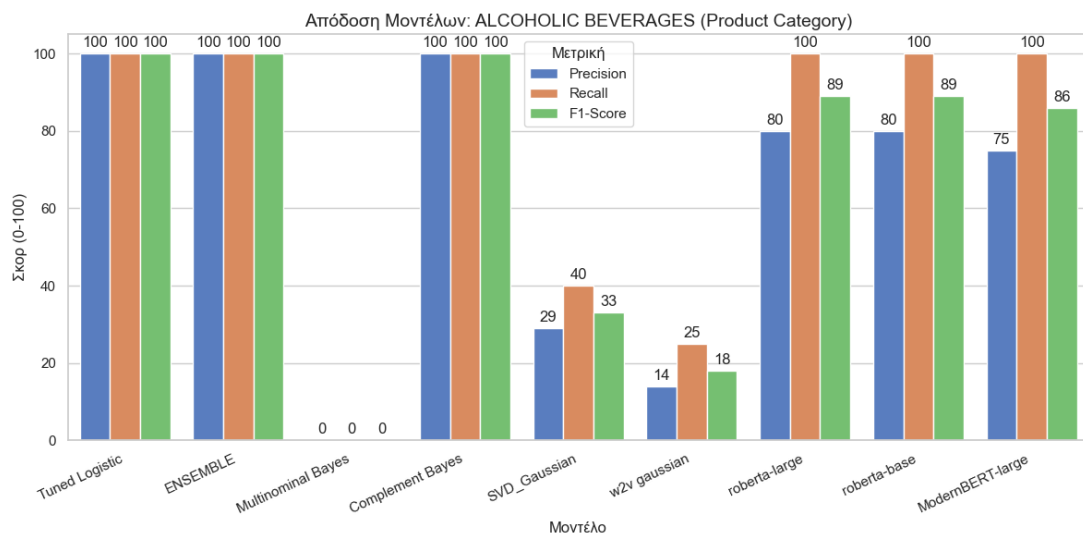
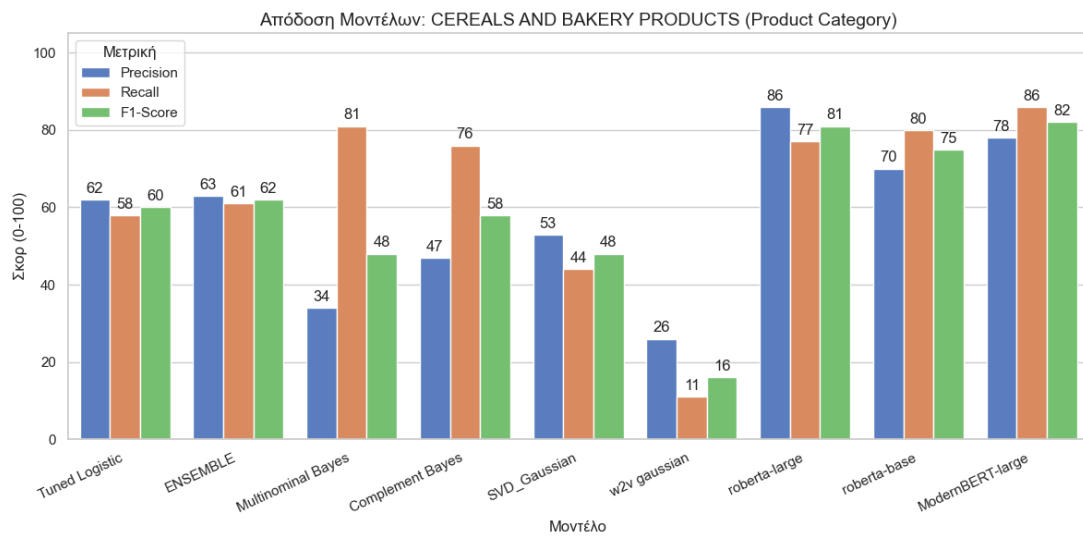
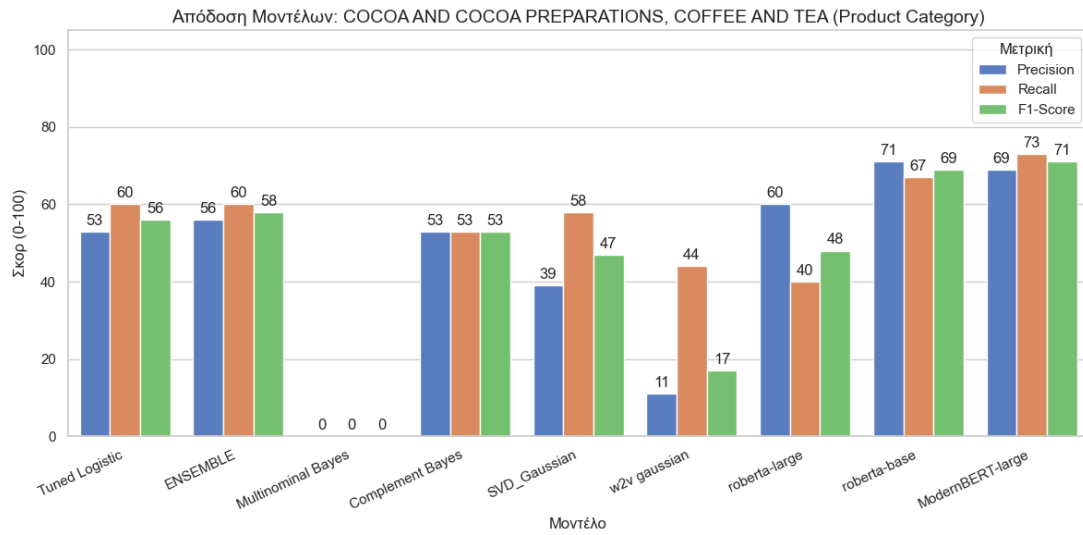




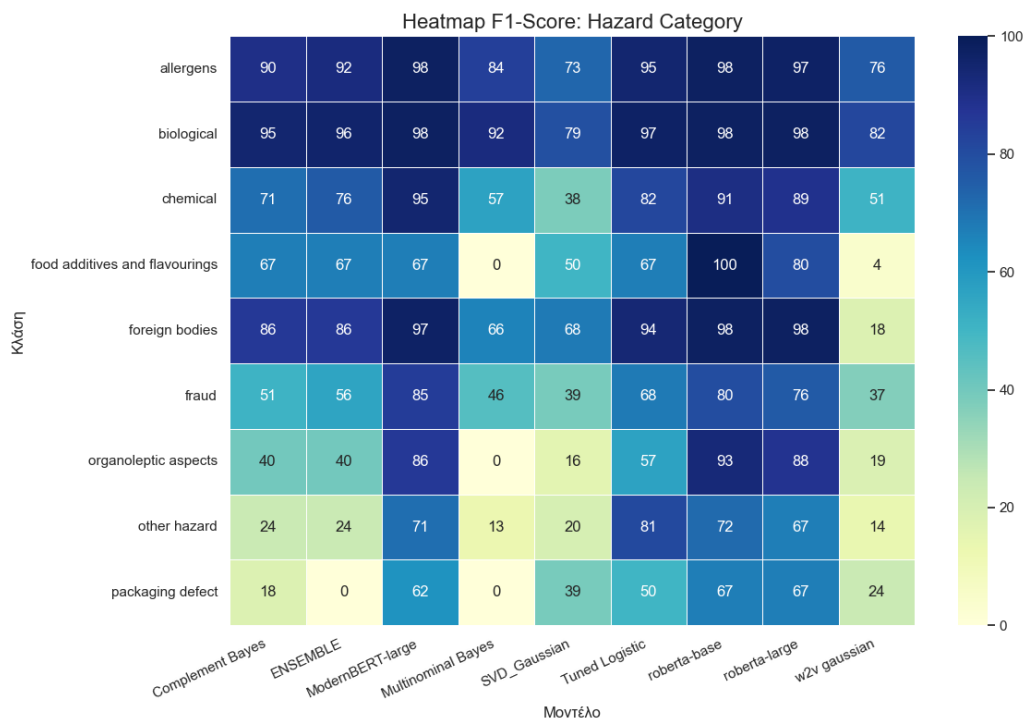
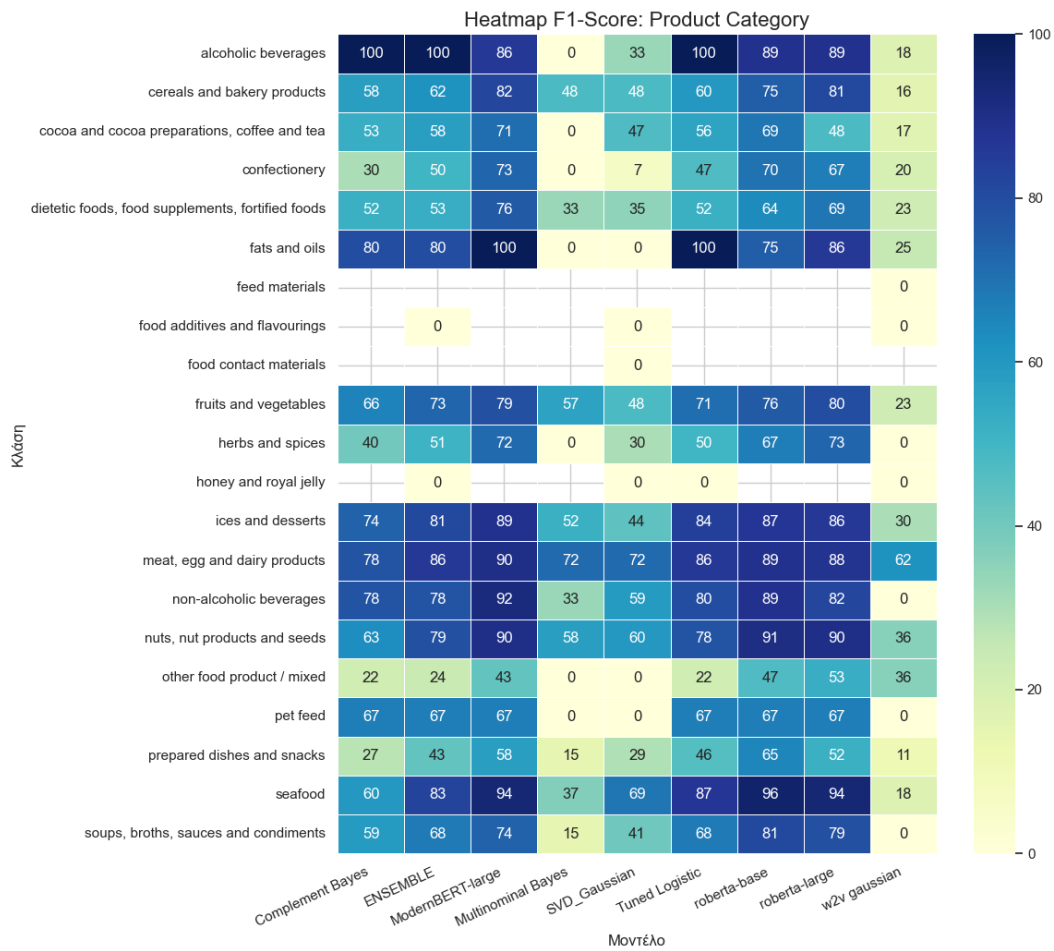




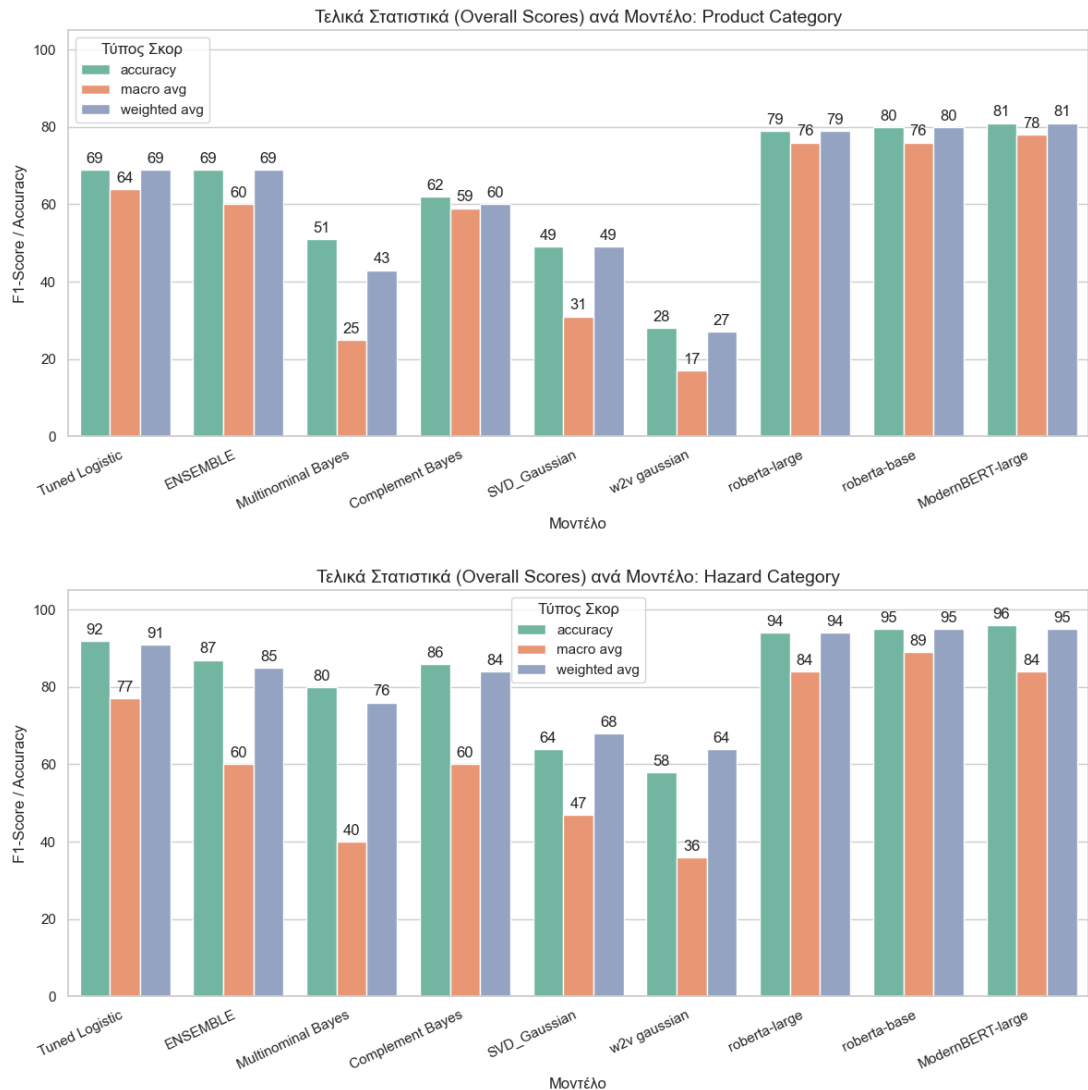




Heatmaps



Overall



Comments About The Charts

From the overall charts we can have a clear picture of the results we got from each method. The worst were the w2v gaussian as well as the svd implementation meaning that the model couldn't create a good enough vector similarity. After that comes the multinomial Bayes which is out scaled massively by the Complement Bayes due to the imbalance of the data. From the baselines methods we can see that the tuned logistic and the ensembled tuned logistic with complement bayes gave a solid result but all of them were outperformed from the "state-of-the-art" transformers. From the charts we can see that all three gave decent and almost identical f1 scores for the hazard category, but Roberta-base gave a little better result for the product category. Finally, the heatmaps revealed the imbalance on the categories that hurt the f1 score (packaging defect, other hazard, other food hazard / mixed etc.) which is helpful determining where our model struggled to predict correctly.

Overall, our opinion is that the logistic regression and complement Bayes gave solid results for the tasks as baseline methods without needing heavy computational power or effort making them work. On the other hand, transformers gave a lot stronger scores on the validation test making it possible to find the rare categories. The downside is that some models require heavy computational power (models were ran in A100 40GB gpu) making sure we can cover the whole text and not lose the meaning. They also require a considerable amount of data to have good predictability, hence the use of data augmentation for categories with low sample. Finally, they need some work achieving the suitable parameters so they can work effectively (token length, batch size, epochs, learning rate).